

Brandon White
EDU 498: Literacy Learning as Social Practice

HRL-Aligned Mini-Unit: “Creativity, Consciousness, and Commerce in Sneaker Culture”

Unit Context:

- This unit will be delivered in a ninth-grade ELA classroom in the Rochester City School district. The classroom is an ICOT class containing 11 students with IEPs and 13 students without. Approximately 42% of the students identify as Black or African-American, 45% identify as Latino, 5% identify as White, and 5% identify as multi-racial. The instructional coaches and administrators have permitted educators to make deviations from the curriculum the district adopted as long as there is evidence of alignment with state standards. This mini-unit occurs after instruction was provided using the district-provided EL curriculum “with fidelity.” According to the most recent benchmark assessment, 8% of students are reading well above benchmark, 15% are reading at benchmark, 38% are reading below benchmark, and 39% are reading well below benchmark. However, students are regularly engaged in rigorous literacy, media literacy, critical literacy, and media literacy skills such as rap lyric recitation, debating the best video game streamers, curating and creating TikTok videos about complex issues, etc.

Description and Purpose:

- Sneakers play a major role in individual and collective expression, as well as in our economy and our environment. In the case of urban Black and Brown youth, sneaker culture can be a highly valued and coveted form of expressing identity. However, little is often understood about the design process that allows consumers to resonate with the designs, and little is often known about the manufacturing or marketing processes that allow for consumers to purchase these designs. Receiving deeper insight into each of these aspects of the shoe industry can deepen and further develop student identity and expression through the art of shoe design and exercising criticality of the sneaker business, a process captured by answering the following essential question: *How can creativity and consciousness be used to design and sell attractive footwear using care-based commerce?* Answering such a question can help students enrich their creative expression in ways that empower themselves and their local, national, and/or international communities.

Literacies Framework (Five Pursuits):

The mini-unit “Creativity, Consciousness, and Commerce in Sneaker Culture” will reflect all five components of Dr. Ghodly Muhammad’s Historically Responsive Literacies:

- **Identity:** Students annotate texts and take notes while watching videos, identifying design values and expressions they would like to express and why expressing those values is vital.

Commented [ac1]: Now that is a hook title if I ever hear one!

- **Skills:** Throughout the lessons, students exercise at least two of the following ELA skills:
 - **RI.9-10.2:** Determine one or more themes or central ideas in a text and analyze its development, including how it emerges and is shaped and refined by specific details; objectively and accurately summarize a text. (RI&RL)
 - **RI.9-10.7:** Analyze how a subject/content is presented in two or more formats by determining which details are emphasized, altered, or absent in each account.
 - **SL.9-10.1d:** Respond thoughtfully to diverse perspectives, summarize points of agreement and disagreement, and, when warranted, qualify or justify personal views and understanding and make new connections in light of the evidence and reasoning presented.
- **Intellect:** Students will more deeply understand the shoe design process, helping them understand why they like or don't like the shoes they see for sale.
- **Criticality:** After watching and reading about the economic and environmental inequities within the sneaker industry and what some shoe companies are doing about it, students will incorporate design and commerce plans that reflect an attempt to sustain people and the environment through the development of their shoes.
- **Joy:** Students will incorporate colors, images, and prints on shoe design templates of their choice that align with their identities and forms of expression.

Commented [ac2]: Appreciative that you took the time to add in the standards!

Name of Unit: “Creativity, Consciousness, and Commerce in Sneaker Culture”	
Name of Lesson: Lesson 1 - “What do kicks mean to us and why?”	Grade Level: 9th Grade
Teacher: Brandon White	
Length of Lesson: Two 45-Minute Periods, or One Block (90 Minutes)	
Students’ Identities and Background: ● 42% Black or African-American ● 45% Latino ● 5% identify as White ● 5% identify as multi-racial. ● 8% of students are reading well above benchmark ● 15% of students are reading at benchmark ● 38% of students are reading below benchmark, ● 39% of students are reading well below benchmark. ● engaged in rigorous literacy, media literacy, critical literacy, and media literacy skills outside of the classroom	

Learning Goals/Objectives	Identities: Scholars will explore what sneakers mean to themselves and to our society as a form of expression and identity. Skills: Scholars will engage in the following NYS reading standard as they explore sneakers, sneaker design, identity, and shoe design. - o RI.9-10.2: Determine one or more themes or central ideas in a text and analyze its development, including how it emerges and is shaped and refined by specific details; objectively and accurately summarize a text. (RI&RL) - o RI.9-10.7: Analyze how a subject/content is presented in two or more formats by determining which details are emphasized, altered, or absent in each account. Intellect: Scholars will deepen their content knowledge about the craft of designing sneakers and the environment in which they are made. Criticality: Scholars will interrogate potentially unhealthy identity formulations centered on sneakers and consider ways to maintain healthy identities. Joy: Scholars will begin to explore and form artistic values and expressions for the shoes they would design.
Layered Texts	Music Video: “Wings” by Macklemore and Ryan Lewis Documentary Series Episode: Abstract: The Art of Design Tinker Hatfield: FootWear Design Web Series Episode: Complex: Jobs Unlisted How To Be A Sneaker Designer For Nike and Jordan Brand
Vocabuluray and Concepts	Vocabulary ● Pitch: A brief persuasive argument designed to convince a person to invest in your idea Concepts ● Self-Esteem and Identity ● Sneaker Fashion as Expression ● Sneaker Design as Expression

Commented [ac3]: Love the intersectional conversation you can facilitate with this pursuit!

	● Craftspersonship
Student Spark Teacher Notes: ● The circle leader can be one of the students if capable and willing. ● Keep questions visibly posted.	Students will engage in a free write activity where they answer each of the following questions: ● What is your favorite shoe, even if you haven't gotten a pair yet? ● When did you first notice these shoes? ● Why is it your favorite pair of shoes? ● If you could do 2-3 things to change the shoe to customize it your way, what would you do? After the free write, students will engage in a Restorative Practice Circle Round (everybody has the opportunity to share one at a time, and circle leaders summarize share outs) where they will be able to share their free write reflections. After sharing, the circle leader will ask one follow-up question: ● Do you like the shoes for your own personal reasons, because your environment says they are cool, or both? Explain your answer.
Body of Lesson Teacher Notes: ● Provide song lyrics in English and Spanish. ● Pause the <i>Abstract</i> video every 10-15 minutes to allow for students to catch up in their notetakers and discuss their findings. ● Pause the <i>Unlisted</i> video after four minutes to allow for students to catch up in their notetakers and discuss their findings. Provide four minutes at the end as well.	Still in the circle, students will view Macklemore and Ryan Lewis's music video "WINGS." After watching the video, students will re-engage the circle, and the circle leader will ask the following question: ● After watching the video, what are some new thoughts you have about why we like sneaker designs? ● How can you make sure that whatever you would design wouldn't be about pressuring yourself or others to fit in? Students will watch <i>Abstract: The Art of Design Tinker Hatfield: FootWear Design</i>, a documentary about a pioneering shoe designer for Nike and Jordan. While watching, students will complete a note catcher that answers the following questions: ● What personal beliefs and values does Tinker Hatfield use to design sneakers? ● How is Tinker Hatfield impacting society with his shoe designs? ● What specific features are you noticing in his shoe designs? ● What adjectives (descriptive words) would you use to

Commented [ac4]: nice revision !

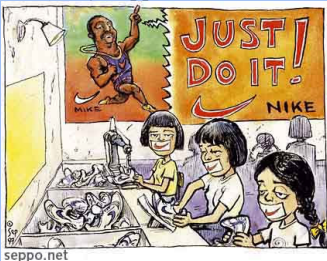
Commented [ac5]: wow- using the restorative circle here signaled me to understand the oppressive nature of sneaker culture. Reminded me of growing up and how people would get beat up, stabbed or even shot for their sneakers- its been a minute since I thought about that. You put it in perspective for me. I wonder if the circle signals the same for students or if you need to explicitly point to why this conversation needs to take place from a space of restoration?

	describe his shoe designs? - What do you notice about how he persuades (or pitches) his designs to people? After watching <i>Abstract</i>, students will watch a web episode of <i>Unlisted</i>, where an inexperienced host engages in the shoe design process led by Dr. Dwayne Edwards at Pensole Lewis College, a shoe-designing school. While watching, students will complete a note catcher that answers the following questions: - What personal beliefs and values does Speedy use to design sneakers? - How does Speedy want to impact society with his shoe designs? - What specific features are you noticing in his shoe designs? - What adjectives (descriptive words) would you use to describe his shoe designs? - What do you notice about how he persuades (or pitches) his designs to people?
Closure	Students will reconvene for Restorative Practice Circle Rounds, where they will be invited to answer the following questions: - What are some findings in your note catcher that taught you a lot about shoe design? - During our pause breaks, what did your peers notice that you might not have noticed or interpreted differently? - What differences did you notice between Speedy's design process ideas and Tinker Hatfield's? Why do you think they were different? - How have Tinker and Speedy helped you think about the kind of shoe you would like to design and why you would like to design it that way?
Assessment Teacher Note: The vision statement draft can be completed individually or collaboratively in up to groups of three.	Based on knowledge and reflections prior to, during, and after viewing the videos, students will create a concise 2-5 sentence Shoe Creation Vision Statement Draft that will reflect their personal design philosophies and approaches.

Name of Unit: “Creativity, Consciousness, and Commerce in Sneaker Culture”	
Name of Lesson: Lesson 2 - “How does the path from kicks design to purchase impact our lives and the environment?”	Grade Level: 9th Grade
Teacher: Brandon White	
Length of Lesson: Three 45-Minute Periods, or One and a Half Blocks (90 Minutes)	
Students’ Identities and Background: ● 42% Black or African-American ● 45% Latino ● 5% identify as White ● 5% identify as multi-racial. ● 8% of students are reading well above benchmark ● 15% of students are reading at benchmark ● 38% of students are reading below benchmark, ● 39% of students are reading well below benchmark. ● engaged in rigorous literacy, media literacy, critical literacy, and media literacy skills outside of the classroom	

Learning Goals/Objectives	Identities: Students will explore how a personal and/or national identification with sneakers relates to and/or impacts the realities of the people who manufacture the sneakers. Skills: Scholars will engage in the following NYS reading standard as they explore the process of the sneaker manufacturing process. - o RI.9-10.2: Determine one or more themes or central ideas in a text and analyze its development, including how it emerges and is shaped and refined by specific details; objectively and accurately summarize a text. (RI&RL) - o SL.9-10.1d: Respond thoughtfully to diverse perspectives, summarize points of agreement and
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	disagreement, and, when warranted, qualify or justify personal views and understanding and make new connections in light of the evidence and reasoning presented. Intellect: Scholars will deepen their content knowledge about the process of manufacturing sneakers and the environment(s) in which it takes place. Criticality: Scholars will evaluate how economically and environmentally equitable the large commercial sneaker manufacturing business is. Joy: Scholars will brainstorm ways both consumers and factory workers can be treated with dignity and respect.
Layered Texts	Report: Clean Clothes Campaign Nike Profile Report Excerpts: Clean Clothes Campaign Stitched under strain - Long term wage loss across the Cambodian garment industry Website: Marketplace The Chinese workers who make your shoes (including Audio) Book Excerpt: Naomi Klein “The Swoosh: The Fight for Good Jobs,” No Logo (pages 4-6) Article: Pro Publica “Nike Pledged to Shrink Its Carbon Footprint. It Just Slashed the Staff Charged With Making That Happen.” by Rob Davis, ProPublica, and Matthew Kish (including Audio)
Vocabulary and Concepts	Vocabulary ● Living Wage: a rate of job pay that allows for the worker to pay for all the necessities of life without having to live in poverty ● International Manufacturing: factory work outside the company’s home country ● Environmental Sustainability: making products for purchase in a way that prevents damage to the planet as a whole or where people live on the planet

	• FOB (Free on Board) Costs: price of goods loaded onto ship at origin, excluding shipping. • Expenses: services and items that must be paid for during the process of running a business • Profit: money made by a business after all expenses have been paid Concepts • Ethical Entrepreneurship
Student Spark Teacher Notes: • The circle leader can be one of the students if capable and willing. • Keep questions visibly posted.	Students will explore the following political cartoons and images that contain messages about Nike: 1) By Seppo Leinonen  2) By Tony Auth  3) ProPublica

Commented [ac6]: the layered text and multi-modal resources are scaffolding understanding across the different literacy levels - really well done!

	After exploring the images, students will engage in a free write activity where they answer each of the following questions: • If you were to summarize the message of each cartoon/image into one “tweetable” statement, what would it be, and why? • What design and artistic choices stand out to you the most in these cartoons/images? How can these choices help you think about your own design and artistic expression? • What are the images making you think about that you haven’t thought about before? • What questions are these images prompting you to ask? After the free write, students will engage in a Restorative Practice Circle Round (everybody has the opportunity to share one at a time, and circle leaders summarize share outs) where they will be able to share their free write reflections. After sharing, the circle leader will ask one follow-up question: • Why may it be vital that people and the planet be treated with dignity during the shoes creation process?
Body of Lesson Teacher Notes: • Use AI services to translate segments of texts for entering and emerging English Learners, inviting developing and expanding	Still in the circle, students will independently read the <i>Clean Clothes Campaign’s Nike Profile</i> that evaluates the wages they provide to factory workers overseas. While reading, students will think about the following: • While reading, what questions are getting answered that you asked during the free write and circle? • What is surprising you, what isn’t surprising you, and why? • How is this impacting your understanding of how the shoes we have get on our feet?

English Learners to proof read it. ● Incorporate text-to-speech software for students who could benefit the most from it.	After reading and thinking, students will stand and find a partner to share and discuss the answers to their reflection questions. After reading the profile and partnering for discussion, students will re-engage the circle, share their reflections, and answer the following question: ● How did your partner deepen your understanding or reflection on the Nike profile? After the circle conversation, students will follow along during a read-aloud of pages 7 and 8 of the Clean Clothes Campaign’s report <i>Stitched under strain - Long term wage loss across the Cambodian garment industry</i>. While reading, the teacher will ask students to identify the following while the teacher captures it on a widely displayed Google Doc, poster paper, etc.: ● What are examples of prioritizing profits over people (if any)? ● What are examples of prioritizing people over profits (if any)? ● What are examples of prioritizing profits over the planet (if any)? ● What are examples of prioritizing the planet over profits (if any)? ● What possibilities for ethical entrepreneurship are being presented by the reading or by your own thinking? After reading pages 7 and 8, half the students will independently read page 23 (a report on an Adidas manufacturer), and the other half will read page 33 (a report on a Nike manufacturer), and in their note catchers, they will answer the “Profit, People, Planet, and Possibilities” questions, then share their answers with a partner who read the opposite report: After returning to the whole group, students will review the “Recommendations” section. As they review, they will share which recommendations they believe would be the most effective, and the teacher will place them on the widely displayed Google Docs, poster paper, etc., under the “possibilities” section.
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Commented [ac7]:
I appreciate shifting the cognitive load of reading the text themselves to having their lift be the identification of these key points

	Next, students will go into three different groups. Each group will read (or listen to) their assigned article independently: Group A: Marketplace The Chinese workers who make your shoes (including Audio) Group B: Naomi Klein “The Swoosh: The Fight for Good Jobs,” No Logo (pages 4-6) Group C: Pro Publica “Nike Pledged to Shrink Its Carbon Footprint. It Just Slashed the Staff Charged With Making That Happen.” by Rob Davis, ProPublica, and Matthew Kish (including Audio) After reading independently, students will join their group members to collaboratively answer the “Profit, People, Planet, and Possibilities” questions on widely displayed google doc or poster paper. After completing the chart, students will complete an in-person (or digital) gallery walk, observing the findings of their peers.
Closure	Students will reconvene for Restorative Practice Circle Rounds, where they will be invited to answer the following questions: • What are some findings in your note catchers that taught you a lot about shoe manufacturing? • What did your peers notice that you might not have noticed or interpreted differently? • How have these reports helped you think about the kind of shoe you would like to design and why you would like to design it that way?
Assessment Teacher Note: • The vision statement draft can be completed individually or collaboratively in up to groups of three.	Based on knowledge and reflections prior to, during, and after reviewing the manufacturing reports, students will revise their concise 2-5 sentence Shoe Creation Vision Statement Draft that will more deeply reflect their personal design and manufacturing philosophies and approaches. Students can extend their Statement Drafts by 1-2 sentences.

Name of Unit: “Creativity, Consciousness, and Commerce in Sneaker Culture”	
Name of Lesson: Lesson 3 - “What does improving the path from design to purchase look like in today’s sneaker industry?”	Grade Level: 9th Grade
Teacher: Brandon White	
Length of Lesson: Six 45-Minute Periods, or Three Blocks (90 Minutes)	
Students’ Identities and Background: • 42% Black or African-American • 45% Latino • 5% identify as White • 5% identify as multi-racial. • 8% of students are reading well above benchmark • 15% of students are reading at benchmark • 38% of students are reading below benchmark, • 39% of students are reading well below benchmark. • engaged in rigorous literacy, media literacy, critical literacy, and media literacy skills outside of the classroom	

Learning Goals/Objectives	Identities: Students will explore how a personal and/or national identification with sneakers relates to and/or impacts the realities of the people who manufacture the sneakers. Skills: Scholars will engage in the following NYS reading standard as they explore the process of the sneaker manufacturing process. - o RI.9-10.2: Determine one or more themes or central ideas in a text and analyze its development, including how it emerges and is shaped and refined by specific details; objectively and accurately summarize a text. (RI&RL) - o SL.9-10.1d: Respond thoughtfully to diverse perspectives, summarize points of agreement and disagreement, and, when warranted, qualify or justify personal views and understanding and
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	make new connections in light of the evidence and reasoning presented. Intellect: Scholars will deepen their content knowledge about the alternative possibilities and processes of manufacturing sneakers and the environment(s) in which it takes place. Criticality: Scholars will identify how economically and environmentally equitable sneaker manufacturing can empower both consumers and manufacturers. Joy: Scholars will commit to ways that both consumers and factory workers can be treated with dignity and respect.
Layered Texts	Video: NBC News “Former inmate launches successful sneaker company” Article: Fox 59 “81% of Americans Want to Buy Shoes Made in the USA, Says New Data Study” by EIN Presswire Article: World Footwear “First black-owned shoe factory in the US launches its first sneaker” Video Series: Jems “Episodes” Article: NPR Why The American Shoe Disappeared And Why It's So Hard To Bring It Back by Alina Selyukh (including Audio) Article: Rolling Stone Best Foot Forward: “These Shoe Brands Pair Style With Sustainability” by Carrie Bell and Nishka Dhawan Article: Shoppe Black “Black Owned Sneaker Brands You Should Know” Website: All American.org Sneakers Made in the USA (including Video)
Vocabulary and Concepts	Vocabulary Domestic Manufacturing: factory work inside the

	company's home country • Living Wage: a rate of job pay that allows for the worker to pay for all the necessities of life without having to live in poverty • Expenses: services and items that must be paid for during the process of running a business • Profit: money made by a business after all expenses have been paid Concepts • Ethical Entrepreneurship • Mission and Expression-Based Entrepreneurship
Student Spark	Students will engage in a free write activity where they answer each of the following question: • What would it take from you and your community to make your Shoe Creation Vision Statement Draft a reality? After the free write, students will watch the NBC News video "<i>Former inmate launches successful sneaker company.</i>" After viewing the video, students will engage in a Restorative Practice Circle Round (everybody has the opportunity to share one at a time, and circle leaders summarize share outs) where they will be able to share their free write reflections. After sharing, the circle leader will ask one follow-up question: • What did it take from Darrell Alston and his community to make his shoe designs and creations a reality? How did he do it as an ethical entrepreneur?
Body of Lesson Teacher Notes: • Pause the <i>Unlisted</i> video after four minutes to allow for students to catch up in their notetakers and discuss their findings. Provide four minutes at the end as well.	Still in the circle, students will independently read the FOX29 article <i>81% of Americans Want to Buy Shoes Made in the USA</i>, <i>Says New Data Study</i>, and the World Footwear article <i>First black-owned shoe factory in the US launches its first sneaker</i>. While reading, students will think about the following: • While reading, what questions are getting answered that you asked during the free write and circle? • What is surprising you, what isn't surprising you, and why? After reading and thinking, students will stand and find a partner to share and discuss the answers to their reflection questions.

● Use AI services to translate segments of texts for entering and emerging English Learners, inviting developing and expanding English Learners to proof read it. ● Incorporate text-to-speech software for students who could benefit the most from it.	After reading the profile and partnering for discussion, students will re-engage the circle, share their reflections, and answer the following question: ● How is this impacting your understanding of how you could realize your Shoe Creation Vision Statement Draft? After the circle, students will watch the short video series <i>Jems: "Episodes,"</i> which tracks the journey and development of a shoe design and release from Dr. Dwayne Edwards at Pensle Lewis College (see Lesson 1), in homage to Black shoemaking pioneer Jan Ernst Matzeliger. While watching, the teacher will ask students to answer the following questions in their note catchers: ● What are examples of prioritizing profits over people (if any)? ● What are examples of prioritizing people over profits (if any)? ● What are examples of prioritizing profits over the planet (if any)? ● What are examples of prioritizing the planet over profits (if any)? ● What possibilities for ethical entrepreneurship are being presented by the reading or by your own thinking? After reading and thinking, students will stand and find a partner to share and discuss the answers to their reflection questions. After reading the profile and partnering for discussion, students will re-engage the circle, share their reflections, and answer the following questions: ● How did your partner deepen your understanding or reflection on how a design can be pursued in a way that shows dignity to yourselves and others? ● What are we learning about the role storytelling plays in designing shoes? Next, students will go into four different groups. Each group will read (or listen to) their assigned article independently: Group A: NPR Why The American Shoe Disappeared And Why It's So Hard To Bring It Back by Alina Selyukh (including
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	Audio) Group B: Rolling Stone Best Foot Forward: “These Shoe Brands Pair Style With Sustainability” by Carrie Bell and Nishka Dhawan Group C: Shoppe Black “ Black Owned Sneaker Brands You Should Know” Group D: All American.org Sneakers Made in the USA (including Video) After reading independently, students will join their group members to collaboratively answer the “Profit, People, Planet, and Possibilities” questions on widely displayed google doc or poster paper. After completing the chart, students will complete an in-person (or digital) gallery walk, observing the findings of their peers.
Closure	Students will reconvene for Restorative Practice Circle Rounds, where they will be invited to answer the following questions: • What are some findings in your note catchers that taught you a lot about dignified ways to approach both shoe design and manufacturing? • What did your peers notice that you might not have noticed or interpreted differently? • How have these articles and videos helped you think about the kind of shoe you would like to design and why you would like to design it that way?
Assessment Teacher Note: • The vision statement draft can be completed individually or collaboratively in up to groups of three.	Based on knowledge and reflections prior to, during, and after reviewing the articles and videos from this lesson, students will revise their concise 2-5 sentence Shoe Creation Vision Statement Draft that will more deeply reflect their personal design and manufacturing philosophies and approaches. Students can extend their Statement Drafts by another 1-2 sentences.

Name of Unit: “Creativity, Consciousness, and Commerce in Sneaker Culture”	
Name of Lesson: “How could your vision of a kicks design and release show who you are while treating people and the planet with dignity?”	Grade Level: 9th Grade
Teacher: Brandon White	
Length of Lesson: Three 45-Minute Periods, or One and a Half Blocks (135 Minutes)	
Students’ Identities and Background: ● 42% Black or African-American ● 45% Latino ● 5% identify as White ● 5% identify as multi-racial. ● 8% of students are reading well above benchmark ● 15% of students are reading at benchmark ● 38% of students are reading below benchmark, ● 39% of students are reading well below benchmark. ● engaged in rigorous literacy, media literacy, critical literacy, and media literacy skills outside of the classroom	

Learning Goals/Objectives	Identities: Scholars will express their artistic and moral values through a shoe design, manufacturing, and marketing plan.
	Skills: Scholars will engage in the following NYS reading standard as they explore the process of the sneaker manufacturing process. - o RI.9-10.2: Determine one or more themes or central ideas in a text and analyze its development, including how it emerges and is shaped and refined by specific details; objectively and accurately summarize a text. (RI&RL) - o SL.9-10.5: Make strategic use of digital media and/or visual displays in presentations to enhance understanding of findings, reasoning, and evidence, and to add elements of interest to engage the audience.

	Intellect: Scholars will deepen their understanding of how sneakers are designed and released. Criticality: Scholars will create a sneaker design, manufacturing, and release plan in a manner that values their identity, the dignity of others, and the dignity of the planet. Joy: Students will incorporate colors, images, and prints on shoe design templates of their choice that align with their identities, values, and other forms of expression.
Layered Texts	Video: Good Morning America Kids design shoes to help benefit other patients just like them Website: Kicksart AI GPT: Imajinn AI Sneaker Generator Website: Vecteezy Shoe Templates
Vocabulary and Concepts	Vocabulary ● Pitch: A brief persuasive argument designed to convince a person to invest in your idea ● Living Wage: a rate of job pay that allows for the worker to pay for all the necessities of life without having to live in poverty ● Environmental Sustainability: making products for purchase in a way that prevents damage to the planet as a whole or where people live on the planet ● Expenses: services and items that must be paid for during the process of running a business ● Profit: money made by a business after all expenses have been paid Concepts ● Self-Esteem and Identity ● Sneaker Fashion as Expression ● Sneaker Design as Expression ● Craftspersonship ● Ethical Entrepreneurship ● Mission and Expression-Based Entrepreneurship
Student Spark	Students will engage in a free write activity where they answer

	each of the following question: - Is there such a thing as being “too young” to pursue your creative ideas? Why or why not? After the free write, students will watch the Good Morning video “<i>Kids design shoes to help benefit other patients just like them.</i>” After viewing the video, students will engage in a Restorative Practice Circle Round (everybody has the opportunity to share one at a time, and circle leaders summarize share outs), where they will be able to share their free write reflections. After sharing, the circle leader will ask one follow-up question: - What did it take from Luna, her peers, and her community to make his shoe designs and creations a reality? How did she do it as an ethical entrepreneur?
Body of Lesson Teacher Note: - If this assignment was done successfully by students in previous years, showcase the student’s work for the students currently experiencing the lesson. - Students can design other footwear such as boots, heels, slides, etc. - The shoe design and development plan can be completed individually or collaboratively in up to groups of three.	Using their creative expression, coupled with the notes from observing shoe design from Tinker Hatfield, Speedy, Dr. Dwayne Edwards, Luna, and the articles about Black-owned sneaker companies and sustainable sneaker companies students will design their own shoes. The following tools can be used for their design: - Website: <i>Kicksart</i> (provides blank templates of popular shoes, along with tutorial videos for how to draw popular shoe designs from scratch). - AI GPT: <i>Imajinn AI Sneaker Generator</i> (generates designs, but can also be used for inspiring designs) - Website: <i>Vecteezy Shoe Templates</i> (provides blank templates of general shoe designs, which is helpful if you want a template, but don’t want to use the design of another established shoe) - Blank paper (provides a “blank canvas” for students who want to build an idea from scratch) Along with designing the shoe using the resources provided, students must identify four answers to each of the following questions for how their shoe will be developed. Students can use the information from their communities and the “Profit, People, Planet, and Possibilities” note catchers and posters for inspiration:

	● In what specific ways will you prioritize people over profits? ● In what specific ways will you prioritize the planet over profits? After designing the shoe and making specific ethical commitments for shoe development and selling, students will add any necessary final revisions to their Shoe Creation Vision Statement Draft they may want to make. After revising the vision statement, students will create a physical (or digital) display where their shoe design is located in the center, their vision statement is above the shoe, their commitments to “people over profit” to the left of the shoe, and their commitments to “planet over profit” to the right of the shoe, and a slogan that describes the design below the shoe.
Closure	Students will display their shoe design displays, sharing their vision and explaining their design and business choices in the process.
Assessment	The display will be assessed for creativity, consciousness, and completeness. Additionally, students will complete a 20-30 sentence reflection where they answer the following questions: ● What inspiration, values, and desires informed your most stand-out design choices? ● What were the highs and lows for you (and your partners if you had them) throughout the development process? ● How has this project changed your thinking about the way you look at the role shoes play in your life? ● How has this project changed your thinking about the way you look at the role shoes play in our society?

Commented [ac8]: I like this component - see it through!

Work Sample

Name: <i>Brandon</i>	
Text: <i>"Nike Pledged to Shrink Its Carbon Footprint. It Just Slashed the Staff Charged With Making That Happen."</i> by <i>Rob Davis, ProPublica, and Matthew Kish</i>	
Examples: profits over people (if any)? <i>firing 30% of environment staff even though the company is still wealthy</i> <i>child labor in 1990s (20 cents an hour)</i>	Examples: people over profits (if any)? <i>against the law to buy cotton made my Uyghurs' forced labor in China</i> <i>Nike was the first in its industry to share supplier info openly</i>
Examples: profits over the planet (if any)? <i>firing a team committed to making Nike more environmentally friendly</i> <i>Nike carbon emission are increasing, not decreasing!</i>	Examples: planet over profits (if any)? <i>using leather instead of kelp for shoes</i> <i>using foam made from plants</i> <i>promised not to use leather that contributes to deforestation</i> <i>use less materials in shoe boxes</i> <i>Puma reduced pollution 33% while doubling revenues</i> <i>Sneakers like Flyknit, Aeroswift, and Space Hippie were popular shoe models that decreased materials</i>
What possibilities for ethical entrepreneurship are being presented by the reading or by your own thinking? <i>Imagining ways to double profits while halving damage done to the planet</i> <i>embracing and leading the charge in "corporate responsibility"</i> <i>Setting environmental goals that match the goals of countries around the world.</i> <i>change factories for goal power to solar or wind power</i> <i>Think about what "disruptive innovation" looks like for serving workers and the planet.</i>	

Personal Reflection

The process of designing this unit was both rigorous and relevant for the kind of educator I would like to be. Throughout the process, I found inspiration and innovation through other folks' texts, tasks, and commitments and within myself. My understanding of and appreciation for, and commitment to, Gholdy Muhammad's Historically Responsive Literacy Framework deepened throughout this project. So much so, that I will be completing my reflections on this project through the lenses of identity, skills, intellect, criticality, and joy.

Identity

My identity as a teacher was both challenged and strengthened through this project. I identified a mini-unit topic (sneaker creation, commerce, and culture) that I knew would resonate with many Black and Brown students I interacted with. Still, I was also worried that choosing this mini-unit topic was too much about my identity as someone who can really appreciate sneakers. Determining what happens to be cultural overlap with your students versus what is teacher identity proselytizing isn't always an easy task. That is why it became important for me to be sure that in the final project, students did not have to design sneakers but any form of footwear. That is why it was also important to explore subtopics about this mini-unit (such as environmental sustainability) that I am not passionate about, but maybe good "mirrors and windows" for students to look through.

Skills

One of the biggest tasks that can burden a teacher is unlearning the compartmentalization of content areas or topics and de-siloing what can be used to build skills. Even as someone who has been practicing this unlearning for a long time, I still had to push my thinking in accepting that it is possible to meld an artistic endeavor like shoe design, a business endeavor like shoe manufacturing/marketing, and a science endeavor like environmental sustainability, into an endeavor that allows students to strengthen ELA skills. In truth, unlike Math or Science Standards, the skills captured in the New York State Standards focus way more on task and less on topic, which theoretically provides breathing room for whatever idea or topics to be integrated into lesson plans. While I still had to be strategic, 9th-grade ELA standards for reading

Commented [ac9]: This is a constant struggle for me too- I have learned that what matters to you matters too- our authentic voices in the classroom (not censored) are liberating for us and exemplify the importance of liberation as well as a path towards it- also the joy we experience sharing passions is infectious

Commented [ac10]: really well integrated

Commented [ac11]: preach!

Commented [ac12]: yes this unit is a prime example of how seamlessly this can be done!

informational texts and speaking and listening were more than compatible with all the topics and subtopics included in the mini-unit.

Intellect

It was refreshing working to cultivate intellect within this mini-unit because I was also cultivating my own intellect about the subject. I received so much insight about how a shoe is designed, especially when I found Dr. Dwayne Edwards' and Tinker Hatfield's work as resources. My respect for the craftspersonship required to design a shoe only deepened, and I worked to create the mini-unit so that students' respect for the craft could also deepen. In particular, deciding to build intellect in a mini-unit primarily focused on a consumed product is important to me because, as young people and people from the United States generally, we don't always understand the craft and the commerce required to buy something we like.

Criticality

As previously mentioned, intellect was about building awareness of the craft and commerce done for us to be sneakers, but it was important to move back and forth between the awareness of intellect and the interrogation of criticality. The sneaker manufacturing and marketing business in the United States and beyond deserves questioning, and little is known about it, especially amongst one of their target demographics: Black and Brown youth. The students deserved opportunities to interrogate practices that put profit over the planet and people and explore how these new understandings shape their view of the sneakers they buy, want, or see. Even for me, encouraging such criticality amongst the students prompts me to look in the mirror and ask, "Who is being harmed by my shoe consumerism"? I have been on quite a shoe consumer journey, going from buying no shoes for years because of questionable business practices, buying shoes from ethical sneaker start-ups, to unapologetically spending a lot of money on shoes without thinking about their journey. Such a mini-unit helps me refine my understanding and commitment to being a conscious consumer.

Joy

While the creation of this mini-unit took place during a hectic time of the year and was arduous to complete as a result, it was still an experience where joy would be present nonetheless. Working on a mini-unit using a framework that aligns so well with my desires for education provided a baseline of joy and comfort. Moments where, after much critical thought, ideas, tasks, and activities were starting to synchronize and patternize around each other produced a feeling of fulfillment for me that also generated sensations of joy. Lastly, feeling free to create a mini-unit of my choice, while daunting at first, produced joy in the long run, and liberty and choice are designed to do.

Commented [ac13]: yes, there is a lot of intersectionality in your unit because of this and it speaks to your ability to make your process visible

Commented [ac14]: full circle - we never stop being learners

Commented [ac15]: if /when you teach this, this reflection could be a powerful way to level with your students too

Brandon,

This is really an extraordinary unit and labor of love that you submitted. I am in awe and just want to commend you for this work of art. Would you mind if I shared this as an example in a future class? See the rubric below for more feedback.

Criteria	Exceeding Expectations	Meeting Expectations	Approaching Expectations	Below Expectations
Identity 3	The unit deeply engages students in exploring and expressing their identities. Lessons incorporate diverse perspectives, student agency, and self-expression. So many opportunities in many diverse ways.	The unit supports identity exploration and incorporates opportunities for self-expression, though depth may be limited.	The unit addresses identity but offers limited opportunities for students to explore or express their own identities.	The unit minimally or inadequately addresses student identity.
Skills 3	The unit effectively builds essential literacy skills, ensuring students develop both foundational and higher-order skills with clear, purposeful activities. Your skill focus is clear and can be directly connected to standards and yet	The unit builds key literacy skills, with clear objectives and activities to support skill development.	The unit touches on skill-building but lacks clear objectives or activities to ensure skill development.	The unit fails to effectively build or address literacy skills.

	provides space for greater depth and wider breadth of understanding that goes far beyond this unit			
Intellect 3	The unit challenges students intellectually, engaging them with complex concepts, ideas, and texts that deepen their understanding and knowledge. As I mentioned in various spots – the rigor and intersectional approach to the pursuits create an intellectually stimulating learning community but one that also holds your students to a high level of academic excellence – you do not shy away from the work , you do not water down the work based on differently abled reading levels, you scaffold the heck out	The unit supports intellectual growth, engaging students with relevant concepts and texts that develop their knowledge.	The unit introduces some complex ideas, but intellectual engagement may be surface-level or inconsistent.	The unit offers little to no intellectual challenge for students.

	of the unit and that is some good work!			
Criticality 3	The unit meaningfully engages students in critical thinking about power, equity, and social justice. Students are encouraged to question and challenge societal norms. 100% you hit this point hard and raised a level of critical consciousness in your student population that will without doubt have a ripple effect on how they engage as consumerists	The unit addresses criticality, prompting students to think about power and social justice, though depth may vary.	The unit touches on criticality but lacks consistent engagement with power, equity, or social justice issues.	The unit does not adequately engage students in critical thinking.
Joy 3	The unit effectively incorporates joy, love, and aesthetic fulfillment. Lessons foster creativity, curiosity, and passion for learning. I really appreciate how you highlight experiencing joy from the struggles –	The unit incorporates joy and engagement, though opportunities for creativity and fulfillment may be limited.	The unit includes some moments of joy or creativity, but these are not central to the learning experience.	The unit lacks engagement or fails to incorporate elements of joy.

	there are many examples of this and while I won't point to each explicitly I think your ability to bring joy into each lesson speaks to your deep connections to this art form			
Lesson Plan Coherence & Engagement 3	Lessons are well-structured, coherent, and engaging. The learning activities align with objectives, and students are meaningfully involved throughout the unit.	Lessons are organized and aligned with objectives. Students are engaged, though some activities may lack depth.	Lessons are somewhat organized but may lack coherence or alignment with objectives. Engagement may be inconsistent.	Lessons are disorganized, lack engagement, or do not align with objectives.
Sample Assignment 3	The sample assignment is thoughtful, detailed, and provides a strong model for students. It reflects deep empathy and realistic expectations for learners.	The sample assignment is clear and demonstrates reasonable expectations, though may lack detail or depth.	The sample assignment is underdeveloped and provides limited guidance for students.	The sample assignment is incomplete or does not offer a helpful model.
Reflection 4	The reflection is highly insightful and demonstrates deep personal and professional growth.	The reflection is thoughtful and demonstrates professional growth.	The reflection touches on personal and professional growth but lacks	The reflection is superficial or fails to connect

	It thoughtfully connects Muhammad's framework, course concepts, and future teaching.	Connections to Muhammad's framework and teaching are clear, though depth may vary.	depth or strong connections to course concepts.	to the course concepts.
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